NUTRILISH

The Macro Counting Cheat Sheet

Your at-a-glance reference for hitting your nutrition goals

QUICK REF

WHAT ARE MACROS?

PROTEIN

4

calories per gram

Builds and repairs muscle tissue. Essential for recovery and body composition.

25–35% of calories

CARBOHYDRATES

4

calories per gram

Primary fuel source for brain and muscle. Powers your workouts and daily activity.

40–50% of calories

FAT

9

calories per gram

Supports hormones, brain health, and absorption of fat-soluble vitamins A, D, E, K.

20–30% of calories

HOW TO CALCULATE YOUR MACROS

1 Calculate Your BMR (Basal Metabolic Rate)

Men: `10 × weight(kg) + 6.25 × height(cm) − 5 × age + 5`

Women: `10 × weight(kg) + 6.25 × height(cm) − 5 × age − 161`

2 Multiply by Your Activity Factor (TDEE)

Sedentary (desk job)	×1.2	Lightly active (1–3 days/wk)	×1.375
Moderately active (3–5 days/wk)	×1.55	Very active (6–7 days/wk)	×1.725

3 Set Your Calorie Goal

Cut (lose fat): TDEE − 500 cal **Maintain:** TDEE ± 0 **Bulk (build muscle):** TDEE + 300 cal

4 Split Your Macros

Set **Protein = 1g per lb bodyweight** (×4 = protein calories). Divide remaining calories between carbs and fat using your target percentages.

WORKED EXAMPLE

180 lb male · moderately active · cutting goal

BMR = 1,890 → TDEE = 2,930 → Target = 2,430 cal

180g	250g	79g	2,430

PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT	TOTAL CAL
720 cal	1,000 cal	710 cal	−500 deficit

TOP PROTEIN SOURCES — RANKED BY EFFICIENCY

FOOD	SERVING	PROTEIN	CALORIES	CAL / G PROTEIN
Tuna (canned, water)	1 can (5 oz)	30g	120	4.0
Chicken Breast	6 oz cooked	42g	187	4.5
Shrimp	6 oz cooked	36g	170	4.7
Turkey Breast	6 oz cooked	38g	180	4.7
Egg Whites	1 cup (243g)	26g	126	4.8
Whey Protein	1 scoop (~32g)	25g	120	4.8
Greek Yogurt (0% fat)	1 cup (227g)	20g	100	5.0
Cottage Cheese (1% fat)	1 cup (226g)	28g	163	5.8

Lower Cal/g Protein = more protein per calorie. Prioritize foods under 5.0 when cutting.

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Quick reference tables & portion guide

QUICK REF

CARBOHYDRATE SOURCES

FOOD	SERVING	CARBS	CAL	FIBER
White Rice	1 cup cooked	45g	206	0.6g
Brown Rice	1 cup cooked	45g	216	3.5g
Oats (rolled)	1/2 cup dry	27g	150	4g
Sweet Potato	1 medium (130g)	27g	112	4g
Banana	1 medium	27g	105	3g
Quinoa	1 cup cooked	39g	222	5g
Whole Wheat Bread	2 slices	24g	140	4g

Prefer higher-fiber sources for satiety and blood sugar control.

HEALTHY FAT SOURCES

FOOD	SERVING	FAT	CAL	TYPE
Avocado	1/2 medium	15g	160	Mono
Olive Oil	1 tbsp	14g	119	Mono
Almonds	1 oz (23 nuts)	14g	164	Mono
Peanut Butter	2 tbsp	16g	190	Mono
Salmon	6 oz cooked	18g	311	Omega-3
Chia Seeds	2 tbsp	9g	138	Omega-3
Walnuts	1 oz (14 halves)	18g	185	Omega-3

Prioritize omega-3 sources (salmon, walnuts, chia) to reduce inflammation.

QUICK PORTION GUIDE — NO SCALE NEEDED

🖐

Palm

1 serving protein
~4 oz cooked

25–35G PROTEIN

✊

Fist

1 serving carbs
~1 cup cooked grain

30–45G CARBS

👍

Thumb

1 serving fat
~1 tbsp nut butter / oil

10–15G FAT

🤲

Cupped Hand

1 serving snack
~1 oz nuts / seeds

14G FAT

👐

Two Hands

1 serving veggies
leafy greens / salad

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Fingertip

1 serving cooking oil
~1 tsp

~5G FAT

Track your macros effortlessly with NutriLish

Snap a photo. Get instant macro breakdowns. AI-powered nutrition tracking that does the math for you.

Download Free →